

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper:

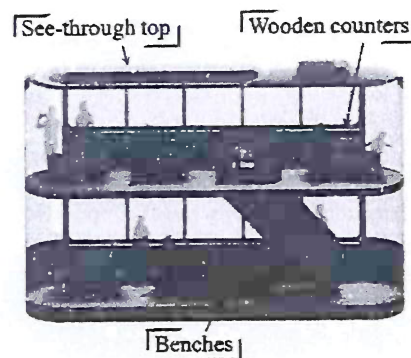
Driverless tram concept for Hong Kong

A design studio has revealed a concept design of an electric double-decker driverless tram to hit the roads of Hong Kong. The giant vehicle, named "Island", won the 2020 GIDA Design Award. The goal of this new concept is to have people use public transport instead of private transport.

In terms of safety, LED lights act as brake lights and headlights to make sure the tram can be seen in all weather conditions. There is no one driving the vehicle, so sensors which can detect surrounding traffic and pedestrians make sure the tram is aware of its surroundings.

The vehicle has a see-through top which lets the sunlight in during the day and lets passengers enjoy the city view at night. There are also bar-like wooden counters on each level, and circular benches inside where passengers sit facing outwards. There are handrails for passengers to hold and enjoy the passing views. The front and back of the tram feature rounded glass windows. This allows for natural light to fill the inside of the tram during the day.

The designer said, "Island represents the forward-thinking spirit of Hong Kong. It tries to introduce a new concept for public transport. Trams are one of the city's icons and this design celebrates their 115th anniversary."



You are members of your school's technology club. Your group has been asked to discuss the driverless tram concept. You may want to talk about:

- whether driverless trams are a good idea for Hong Kong
- whether the public would like this design
- other features which could be added to the tram
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you often take the tram?
2. Would you ride on a driverless tram?
3. Is public transport in Hong Kong too crowded?
4. Are trams a good mode of transport?
5. Are trams getting less popular in Hong Kong?
6. Should more people use public transport?
7. Will driverless vehicles become more common in Hong Kong?
8. How can the tram company make more money?